



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Greyfriars Classical Academy
School Website: <https://greyfriarsclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Greyfriars Classical Academy (GCA) presents a clearly Christian, classical education model blended with a university-style schedule and a Trivium-oriented curriculum. Public materials describe a Christian, covenantal framework anchored in theology (including Westminster Confession of Faith) and a curriculum that emphasizes grammar, logic, and rhetoric, along with history, literature, languages, and theology. The school emphasizes formation of character and wisdom in service of a biblical worldview, with explicit statements about forming "intelligent thinkers" who think God's thoughts after Him and about shaping future generations for the Kingdom. The faculty are described as qualified, mission-driven teachers who constitute the living curriculum, and there is explicit emphasis on partnering with Christian families. The overall public messaging aligns with a Classical/Christian model and demonstrates many core elements of a classical education, though some elements central to a full Great Books-centric formation are less explicit in the site materials.

- Strong Classical/Christian orientation (theology integrated with disciplines; covenantal framing; Westminster Confession of Faith; biblical worldview). Evidence: explicit theology integration and public articulation of the Statement of Faith; biblical worldview pervading subjects.
- Curriculum emphasizes grammar, logic, rhetoric and a university-model schedule (on-campus and home study days) with History, Literature, Math, Science, Greek/Spanish, Theology, and Aesthetics. Evidence: curriculum listing and university-model schedule.
- Faculty described as mission-driven, "living curriculum," with biographies and explicit emphasis on Christian/classical formation. Evidence: Our Faculty page and bios.
- Parent/community emphasis appears as partnership with families and open pathways for parent involvement, including a parent handbook and emphasis on collaboration with Christian families. Evidence: Parent-focused handbook language and mission statements.

Abstract assessment: CLASSICAL overall, with some room to more fully articulate the Great-Books-driven "Great Conversation" and explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades, which would push certain categories toward a fuller classical standard.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials present Greyfriars as a Christian high school with theology integrated across subjects and a biblical worldview. Statement of Faith and Reformed Presbyterian/theology orientation are explicit, including Westminster Confession of Faith.
 - The curriculum is described as theology-informed and covenantal, with an explicit Christian framework guiding instruction.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive indicators present: theology, biblical worldview, covenantal, Westminster Confession, Christian identity, sacred/holy framing (worship language is implied by liturgical/communal framing in the philosophy). These align with Positive Keywords in the Six Elements lexicon (theology, sacred tradition, logos, virtue aligning with a Christian metaphysical frame).
 - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (no strong relativism, secular humanism signals, or value-neutral stance observed on the site).
 - Why this rating
 - The materials clearly ground education in a Christian metaphysical frame, with theology as a governing lens and explicit confessional theology. This aligns with the Positive Indicators for Grounded Theology, liturgical vitality (communion/worship implied through covenantal language), and biblical worldview.

Citations: Greyfriars' Christian identity and theological grounding are described in multiple pages, including "What is Greyfriars?" and the Statements of Faith, with a covenantal and Westminster-based theological stance.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission/goal statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, shaping "intelligent thinkers" who think God's thoughts after Him and aim to transform future generations for the Kingdom. There is explicit focus on character and formation, not merely information or career prep.
 - Wording such as "classical, Christian, covenantal" and "grammar, logic, rhetoric" as a path to formation reflects paideia-style aims beyond mere test scores.
 - "The goal is for students to present ideas effectively" and the emphasis on a timeless, time-tested education signals formation toward virtue and human excellence.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, great conversation, classical mission, moral imagination, reverence, wonder. These map to Positive Keywords in the classical lexicon.
 - Negative keywords: not observed (the site does not emphasize purely vocational training or workforce-readiness at the expense of formation).
- Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty in a way that aligns with classical aims of character formation and wisdom, rather than exclusively job-readiness.

Citations: Mission/goal language and formation emphasis are explicit in the admissions/educational philosophy sections and the mission statements.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the broader liberal-arts trajectory, with a history-literature-languages-science-math-Spanish-Greek-Philosophy-and-theology lineup. The explicit focus on grammar/logic/rhetoric is present; Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit Great-Books requirements are not clearly stated on the site, though "Great Books" messaging appears in the classical education lexicon rather than as a clear site promise.
 - The curriculum listing includes History and Philosophy, Literature, Math, Science, Language (Greek/Spanish), Logic & Rhetoric, Theology, and Aesthetics; this aligns with the basic liberal-arts framework and Trivium pedagogy, though the Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis is not explicit in the site copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), history/philosophy, literature, languages, theology, aesthetics. This matches core elements of the “Seven Liberal Arts” and the traditional Trivium emphasis.
- Negative indicators present: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language or primary-source canonical reading on the public site; no explicit quadrivium/mathematics-musica-astronomy integration described publicly.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum clearly centers around the Trivium and liberal-arts structure, which is a hallmark of classical education. However, the absence of explicit Great Books/primary-text canon emphasis in the site copy (as opposed to what a full classical program with Great Books would require) means it does not fully meet the canonical “Great Books/Great Conversation” criterion in the public-facing materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for the category.

Citations: Curriculum statements and subject list appear in the site copy; Great Books/Great Conversation language is present in classical education literature but not explicitly promised on the site.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site describes a university-model class schedule (three days on campus, two days at home), which is a distinctive pedagogical structure, and a focus on grammar/logic/rhetoric as core. This points to structured, discipline-based pedagogy rather than a purely modern, project-based approach.
 - There is emphasis on the educated rhetoric, with opportunities for students to present and engage in argument (rhetoric focus is named in curriculum). However, explicit Socratic seminars, seminars, or debates, and a clearly articulated progressive sequence (Socratic pedagogy in upper grades) are not heavily evidenced in the public copy.
 - Some elements described in classical literature about pedagogy (scolè, contemplative/restful learning, memory-chanting in some stages) are not explicitly described in the public site materials; those elements appear in the classical-rubric documents, not in the direct site copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators present: rhetoric training, grammar/logic/rhetoric, disciplined memory-related practices (implied by Trivium orientation and disciplined schedule), formal structure (university-model). These map to several Positive Pedagogy keywords in the Six Elements lexicon (Socratic dialogue, rhetorical training, seminars, etc., are relevant, though the explicit Socratic/seminar language is not strongly evidenced on the site).
 - Negative indicators present: lack of explicit Socratic seminars, explicit memory-chanting, or scholé days language on the site; absence of explicit project-based or experiential-learning emphasis in the public copy. The Six Elements negative keywords list such patterns as warnings for not fully classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating
 - Pedagogical methods shown (university-model, emphasis on Trivium) demonstrate classical practices, but the lack of explicit Socratic/seminar and deeper contemplative/restful pedagogy descriptions in the public materials suggests the pedagogy is not yet fully aligned with the strongest classical pedagogy signals in the rubric.

Citations: University-model schedule and Trivium emphasis appear in the public copy; Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not strongly evidenced in the site copy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site highlights a faculty that is “qualified,” “gifted,” and committed to Christian/classical education, with detailed faculty bios and a biography page. The faculty are described as “the living curriculum” and a core of the school.

- The administrative structure emphasizes a headmaster, governance by a board, and a staff of teachers who bring varied professional backgrounds but share a common commitment to classical education. This supports a model where teachers are central to the school's formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators present: model teachers, living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher expectations, collaborative culture (from the “Our Faculty” content). These align with Positive Keywords around “Faculty” in the Six Elements lexicon (model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, collegial culture).
 - Negative indicators: none evident in the public materials; the faculty are described in terms of mission alignment and Christian formation rather than purely credentialing jargon that would contradict classical aims.
- Why this rating
 - The evidence shows a strong, formation-focused faculty profile with explicit language about virtue, mentorship, and living curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL signals for the Faculty category.

Citations: Our Faculty page and bios, plus leadership/headmaster information.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Mission statements emphasize assisting Christian families and covenantal education; non-discriminatory policies are in place; and there is clear language about partnering with parents. There is a handbook that codifies the mission and emphasizes parent-school partnership and parental involvement in the education process.
 - Admissions/Open Houses, inquiries, and a structured communications pathway signal an active, open campus posture and ongoing parental engagement opportunities.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators present: partnership with families, parent formation, shared mission, open campus, opportunities to engage (book studies, gatherings) as seen in the knowledge of the Six Elements lexicon and the lexicon. The parent handbook language aligns with “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections.”
 - Negative indicators: none evident in the public copy; no strong consumer-only framing; rather, ongoing parental involvement is encouraged.
- Why this rating
 - The site materials strongly emphasize parent partnership and community formation with explicit reference to parents as co-educators, aligned with classical-community expectations for the Parents & Community category.

Citations: Parent Handbook language and mission statements; parent-admissions open-house content.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Make explicit the Great Books/Great Conversation component in public-facing materials, with a public statement about primary texts, canonical authors, and cross-disciplinary Great-Book integration. Also consider clarifying Quadrivium components if included (e.g., music/geometry/arithmetic) to signal full liberal-arts breadth.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Explicitly describe Socratic/seminar-based practices in upper grades, and include a clear articulation of scholé/restful learning practices (memory work, recitation, chanting) as part of daily pedagogy, aligning with classical pedagogy signals.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand communications to include more explicit parent-formation opportunities (book groups, parent seminars on classical pedagogy, liturgical rhythms in the home) and more routine open-campus events that invite ongoing parental formation beyond admission cycles.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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